

Corporate Social Responsibility ICON-INSTITUTE Consulting Group

Providing solutions. Taking responsibility. Catalysing change.

For decades, ICON has embraced responsibility for both people and the environment, contributing actively to positive social development in the countries where we operate. Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) is a core element of our philosophy — whether in relation to our clients, beneficiaries, employees, partners, or environmental protection.

Social, ethical, and environmental standards are integrated into every decision made at ICON. These standards are continuously evolving to reflect the changing social landscape, ensuring that our CSR commitments remain relevant and impactful.

Core Values: Appreciation, Ecological Responsibility, Economic Stability

Our CSR strategy is based on three key pillars:

Appreciation Our success is deeply rooted in the strength of our employees. ICON is committed to being a fair and inclusive employer, fostering a culture of cooperation and diversity. We focus on nurturing the unique potential of each employee, recognizing their critical role in the company's success.

Ecological Responsibility We are committed to sustainable business practices. Resource management, minimizing environmental impact, and considering health and social benefits are central to all our projects, programs, and activities. These values guide our approach to ensuring a greener, more sustainable future.

Economic Stability Economic sustainability is the foundation of ICON's operations. By engaging in ongoing dialogue with stakeholders and maintaining a focus on long-term value creation, we have secured 50 years of success. Our commitment to economic responsibility ensures that we remain a stable and reliable partner in all our endeavors.

CSR in Action at ICON

ICON's commitment to CSR is reflected in various activities, projects, and programs that promote improvements in social, environmental, and economic sectors:

Climate Change and Carbon Footprint Reduction ICON is actively committed to reducing its carbon footprint and mitigating climate change. We continually assess our operations and supply chains to identify opportunities for lowering emissions. This includes transitioning to renewable energy sources, optimizing transportation, and implementing energy-efficient practices across our offices and projects, e.g. utilizing a geothermal heat pump system, water recycling, green energy and maintaining a paperless office.

Human Rights and Supply Chain Transparency We are dedicated to upholding human rights in all areas of our operations and supply chains. ICON rigorously monitors its suppliers to ensure that no exploitation, forced labor, or human trafficking takes place. We are committed to full transparency and ethical sourcing in all business practices, ensuring that our suppliers comply with international human rights standards.

Non-Discrimination, Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion ICON values every employee and candidate as a unique individual across all levels of the company. We embrace the diversity they bring and strictly enforce a non-discrimination policy. We believe that every person should be treated equally, regardless of race, gender identity, sexual orientation, national origin, native language, religion, age, disability, marital status, citizenship, genetic information, pregnancy, or any other characteristic protected by law.

Digital Responsibility and Ethical Technology Use As part of our digital transformation, ICON ensures the ethical use of technology. We are committed to data privacy, cybersecurity, and the responsible use of artificial intelligence (AI) in our projects. Our technology practices are designed to enhance transparency, protect personal data, and ensure fair decision-making processes.

Mental Health and Wellbeing ICON recognizes that employee wellbeing goes beyond physical health. We are committed to fostering a work environment that supports mental health and family friendly flexible working arrangements. By creating a supportive workplace, we aim to ensure that our employees thrive both personally and professionally. We provide an on-site company kindergarten to help employees balance their family and career commitments.

Qualitative growth, job security, and sustainable revenue generation:

- We continue to drive growth while ensuring that we maintain stable, long-term employment for our staff. Our staff benefits from profit-sharing and comprehensive occupational pension schemes.
- Profits are reinvested into the company, increasing independence from external shareholders and banks, thus ensuring long-term financial stability.
- ISO 9001:2015 certification: We maintain rigorous quality assurance in our consulting services.

At ICON, CSR is more than just a policy — it is an everyday practice that ensures our success goes hand in hand with our social and environmental responsibilities. By adapting to today's challenges, we continue to make a positive impact on the world around us.

Cologne, October 2024


